

PROSPER AWUNI

IT Cyber Security Specialist / Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | CISSP | Hybrid, London

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience taking ownership of cybersecurity controls, incident response, threat monitoring and vulnerability management across large enterprise environments. I have demonstrable expertise in designing, integrating and managing complex security architectures using Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) -- including Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI) and Defender for Microsoft 365 -- and CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR). I use Kusto Query Language (KQL) to build detection rules, threat hunting hypotheses and operational dashboards, and I advise infrastructure teams on security-focused designs that align with Zero Trust principles. Reporting into infrastructure engineering leadership, I work closely with technology operations teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents, and continuously improve the organisation's security posture. My background spans enterprise Active Directory, Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) Single Sign-On (SSO), Group Policy Objects (GPO), Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), giving me broad capability across the Windows Server infrastructure stack.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM, detection rule authoring, KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (XDR), Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, Next-Generation SIEM), real-time telemetry analysis, policy tuning, exclusion management
- **Threat Monitoring and Threat Hunting:** KQL-based detection engineering, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, proactive threat hunting, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle (preparation, detection, containment, eradication, recovery), root cause analysis, post-incident reporting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), risk-prioritised remediation, penetration test finding management
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure AD Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Windows Server Infrastructure:** Active Directory (AD DS), DNS, DHCP, Group Policy Objects (GPO), Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), Windows Server 2016/2019/2022
- **Device and Application Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM/Mobile Application Management (MAM), device compliance enforcement, endpoint hardening
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email gateway, URL filtering, anti-phishing and impersonation controls
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, KQL, SOAR automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst (Engineer)

March 2025 – Present

- Take full ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture, working closely with infrastructure operations and other technology teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents and strengthen the organisation's overall security posture.

- Design, integrate and manage Microsoft Sentinel as the enterprise SIEM, authoring KQL detection rules, building automated SOAR playbooks and producing dashboards to support threat monitoring and reporting to senior stakeholders.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365, leveraging XDR correlation to detect and respond to advanced threats across the estate.
- Operate CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the enterprise estate, tuning prevention policies, managing threat intelligence integration and leading Falcon NG-SIEM deployment.
- Lead proactive threat hunting campaigns using KQL and MITRE ATT&CK-mapped hypotheses, uncovering hidden threats and misconfigurations before they escalate to incidents.
- Manage and improve the Privileged Access Management (PAM) programme using BeyondTrust, implementing just-in-time access provisioning, session recording and credential vaulting.
- Oversee Microsoft Entra ID and Azure AD Conditional Access policies, Single Sign-On (SSO) integrations and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement for 8,000+ users, advising the infrastructure team on Zero Trust-aligned access design.
- Maintain Group Policy Objects (GPO), Active Directory security configuration and Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) certificate lifecycle management in collaboration with the Windows Server infrastructure team.
- Administer Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), designing and enforcing compliance policies across Windows, macOS, iOS and Android devices.
- Communicate complex security risks and control recommendations to both technical infrastructure teams and non-technical senior leadership, translating threat intelligence into actionable business decisions.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security

March 2022 – March 2025

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity and Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 across an 8,000-user estate, significantly improving threat detection coverage and XDR correlation capability.
- Used Microsoft Sentinel and KQL to monitor security events, write custom analytic rules, and investigate alerts, reducing false positive rates through continuous rule refinement.
- Performed threat monitoring using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, detecting lateral movement, credential abuse and data exfiltration with MITRE ATT&CK-guided hunting exercises.
- Managed Azure AD Conditional Access, MFA and SSO policies, onboarding new applications under Zero Trust principles and enforcing role-based access controls.
- Supported Active Directory, Group Policy Objects (GPO), DNS and DHCP security reviews, identifying and remediating misconfigurations in the Windows Server infrastructure environment.
- Conducted vulnerability monitoring using Tenable.io, Nessus and Pentra BAS, prioritising critical findings and tracking remediation against agreed SLA timelines.
- Led incident response investigations following the NIST 800-61 lifecycle, producing post-incident reports with root cause analysis and lessons-learned recommendations for infrastructure engineering leadership.
- Administered Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies, maintaining device compliance and enforcing security baselines across the endpoint estate.

IT Engineer: Security Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Delivered IT security and infrastructure engineering across a cloud-first Software as a Service (SaaS) environment, implementing endpoint protection, Azure AD-based identity controls and network monitoring.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies, security hardening of cloud-joined endpoints and access control provisioning aligned to least-privilege and Zero Trust principles.
- Administered Active Directory, Group Policy Objects (GPO) and PKI certificate services, supporting Windows Server infrastructure operations and security compliance activities.
- Supported security incident investigations, vulnerability remediation and IT quality assurance activities contributing to ISO 27001 compliance, communicating findings clearly to technical and non-technical stakeholders.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led deployment and integration of Microsoft Sentinel SIEM with KQL-authored detection rules and SOAR playbook automation, improving threat visibility and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) across the enterprise.
- Rolled out Microsoft Defender XDR (Endpoint, Identity, Microsoft 365) to 8,000 users, establishing full-estate XDR coverage and enabling correlated cross-domain threat detection.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM enterprise-wide, delivering complete endpoint telemetry visibility and enabling rapid threat hunting across the environment.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), eliminating uncontrolled privileged access and delivering auditable just-in-time session management for critical infrastructure accounts.
- Redesigned Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA policies under Zero Trust principles for 8,000+ users, measurably reducing credential-based incidents and improving identity security posture.
- Established vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, Nessus and Pentera BAS, systematically reducing critical and high-severity findings and ensuring compliance with Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Regularly briefed infrastructure engineering leadership and senior stakeholders on security posture, threat landscape and remediation progress, translating technical risk into clear business language.

EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.) Environmental and Resource Engineering
- Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)